

FINAL REPORT



Second General Service Conference of A. A.



1952

T A B L E O F C O N T E N T S

REPORT OF SECOND GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF A. A.

1952

"THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE"	3
REPORTS	
Reports of the Board of Trustees	5
Financial Statements of The Alcoholic Foundation and Subsidiaries	6
General Service Office	7
"It's a Question of Lives That May be Lost"	8
The A. A. Grapevine	11
Foundation Literature	12
PANEL DISCUSSIONS	
Local Group Problems	13
Central and Intergroup Office Set-ups	14
Deviations From Traditions & Relations With State & Local Commissions on Alcoholism	15
Demonstrations of Delegates' Work With Local Committees and Groups	16
POLICY SESSIONS	
Non-Alcoholic Trustees	17
Congressional Incorporation	18
Terms of Office of Delegates	19
Family Groups	20
Literature	21
FINAL CONVENTION SESSION	
Advisory Actions adopted by the Conference	22
"We Seek Not Compromise but Certainty" - Mr. Smith	25
"We Face the Sunrise in High Hopes" - Bill	27
APPENDICES	
I. Financial Statements	29
II. Contributions, by State - 1951	38
III. Summary of Operations - The A. A. Grapevine	39
IV. G. S. O. Handling of Mail	41
V. Roster of 1952 Delegates	43
VI. Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation	45
VII. Conference Committees and Staff Personnel	46

"THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE"

The 1952 General Service Conference of A. A. was conducted in an atmosphere of progress, humility and a growing awareness of the importance of the unifying spiritual principles upon which the Society is based.

Without question, the Conference was a memorable milestone in the history of the movement. "For the first time in all A. A. history," as Bill remarked at the informal reception that opened the gathering, "there is now a broad, complete and reliable cross-section of A. A. opinion with which to fortify our headquarters and with which we can deal with the problems of the future as they come to us."

Progress in developing and strengthening the services which constitute the "third legacy" of the founders was apparent in many reports tracing work accomplished since the first panel of the Conference convened in 1951.

Humility was the keynote of all general discussions of specific problems and proposed policies. Time after time, delegates voluntarily reminded themselves (and others) that the purpose of the Conference was not to govern the Society but to serve it.

The spiritual overtones of the Conference were sounded by Mr. Bernard Smith, non-alcoholic chairman of the Board of Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation, at the opening session of the Conference:

"We stand here upon a star in God's universe of stars. There are no boundaries to our hearts save the sky above us and the star below us that some men call the earth. To the left and to the right, there must never be boundaries. There must be no walls. The doors of Alcoholics Anonymous must ever remain open to those who suffer.

"We here must dedicate ourselves to insure that there is never any government in the hearts of Alcoholic Anonymous. And so what we do here is designed to the purpose of insuring that there be no government, no power, no money, nothing save an assurance that somewhere rests sufficient authority to insure that these principles are maintained."

One of the most inspiring quotations heard during the Conference was cited by Mr. Smith in his opening remarks. It was attributed to the noted English religious leader, Canon C. E. Raven, during a British Broadcasting Company program earlier this year.

"Three conditions are necessary for true fellowship: The possession of a common ideal involving a complete release from selfishness and division. The discharge of a common task big enough to capture the imagination and give expression to loyalty. And the comradeship, the "togetherness" thus involved as we find out the joy and power of belonging to an organic society and engaging in a whole-time service. ...We can find it at its fullest where the ideal is highest and most exacting, where the task extends and integrates every ounce of our strength and every element in our being, where the comradeship is so

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE
(Continued)

solid and deep that we respond one to another without conscious effort, realize the unspoken need and react to it spontaneously and at once.

"Under such conditions, all the vitality that we usually waste upon our jealousies and our vanities---upon keeping up appearances and putting other people in their proper place---becomes available for creative use".

At the request of the delegates themselves, all sessions of the Conference opened with recitation of the A. A. Serenity Prayer and closed with the Lord's Prayer. During the periods encompassed by these prayers, delegates:

1. Heard reports of activity during the past year by headquarters service groups, including the Grapevine.
2. Heard and approved Bill's outline of his future proposed services to the Society, now that the Third Legacy has been accepted.
3. Discussed and approved proposals to strengthen specific headquarters services, notably in the field of A. A. literature.
4. Joined in "panel" discussions of specific problems that seemed to be common to A.A. groups throughout the country.
5. Asked the General Service Office to provide certain additional services for the groups.
6. Registered certain "Advisory Actions" on key questions of policy presented to the Conference.

Details of these and other aspects of the first full General Service Conference are noted in succeeding pages of this conference report.

What cannot be recorded adequately was the all-pervading feeling of wonder and gratitude that such a society as Alcoholics Anonymous has come to pass, the consciousness of the tremendous need to preserve and cherish our simple spiritual principles and our overwhelming sense of responsibility for carrying the message of the A.A. program of recovery to the "million who still don't know."

REPORT OF THE BOARD OF TRUSTEES

The frequent and important use of committees is a distinguishing feature of operations of the Board of Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation, Chairman Smith told the delegates during a brief review of Trustees' meeting minutes during the past year.

What the minutes cannot emphasize, the Chairman said, are such "really important factors" as the stimulation and seriousness felt by all who take part in the meeting.

All alcoholic Trustees are now elected annually and none may serve more than four terms, Mr. Smith reported. He announced that the question of whether or not there is a continuing need for non-alcoholic trustees would be taken up at a later policy session of the Conference and reiterated his previously-stated belief that he should retire at the end of the current year.

"We have already provided rotation for the alcoholic members of the Board. I believe that this same concept should be extended to the non-alcoholic Trustees since I believe that they, too, must taste the sobering draft of anonymity." (The Conference later refused to approve this principle).

Mr. Smith noted that the financial situation of the Foundation had improved and attributed a large measure of the improvement to the work of delegates to the 1951 panel.

The Trustees have accepted the charter of a Michigan corporation using the A.A. name and are taking the same steps with respect to a corporation known as A.A. of New York, he said.

Changes in the Board of Trustees since the 1951 Conference were reported as follows:

Mr. Jack Alexander to succeed Mr. Austin MacCormick
Gerald McComber to succeed Thomas Birrell
Henry Zoeller to succeed Thomas Kerr

During the year Robert Bender had been forced, by the pressure of work, to resign as president of Works Publishing, Inc. and as chairman of the General Service Committee. He was succeeded by Robert Hitchins.

FINANCIAL STATEMENTS OF THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION AND SUBSIDIARIES

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC. is a membership corporation whose general purpose is the rehabilitation of chronic alcoholics. This corporation owns all the outstanding stock of WORKS PUBLISHING, INC, whose functions are the publication and distribution of approved books and pamphlets, and the operation of the General Service Office. The Foundation also owns the beneficial interest in the net assets and income of THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC., whose functions are the publication and distribution of our monthly magazine. Detailed financial statements appear in the Appendix. Highlights may be summarized as follows:

1. Contributions from the groups during 1951 were approximately \$21,000 above contributions during 1950. The increase was credited to the work of delegates to the 1951 Conference in making the groups in their areas aware of services rendered by the headquarters office.
2. The General Service Office operated at a small deficit (\$17.83) during the year ended December 31, 1951. The deficit the previous year had been (\$12,853). Despite the progress indicated, the continuing deficit is disturbing in the light of the need to build, rather than to further deplete, Foundation reserves.
3. In 1949 and 1950 the Trustees transferred a total of \$24,000 from the Reserve Fund to the Group Contribution fund to keep the Headquarters Office in operation. This "loan" has not yet been repaid.
4. Sales by Works Publishing, Inc., of books, pamphlets, recordings and other material increased from \$85,160 in 1950 to \$94,227 in 1951.
5. The A.A. Grapevine, which had had an annual operating deficit of \$6,755 at the end of March, 1951, showed net income for the year of \$593 at the end of March, 1952. The Grapevine still carries on its books an advance from The Alcoholic Foundation of \$13,660 which, it is hoped, can be repaid rather than written off.

The net impression derived from careful analysis of all financial statements relating to The Alcoholic Foundation is that the movement is in a healthier position, financially, than it has been since the "explosive" expansion stage of the Society got under way about a decade ago.

It should be recognized however, that the Foundation does not yet have reserves of the size deemed desirable for a Society of this type (i.e.: funds adequate to support essential services for a period of two to three years, even if no additional income should be received) and that both the "Grapevine" and the Group Fund still "owe" substantial sums to the Reserve Fund.

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE

(The General Service Office of A.A. is under the supervision of a committee of seven members, including: one committeeman who acts as chairman and president of Works Publishing, Inc., four representatives of the Board of Trustees of the Foundation, the editor of the "Grapevine" and one general secretary from the G.S.O. itself.)

More than 131,000 individual pieces of mail left the General Service Office during the 12 months ended March 31, 1952, the chairman of the General Service Committee told the delegates.

This mail which, in the aggregate, approximated 56 tons, was in answer to nearly 26,000 pieces of incoming mail handled by the Service Office staff. The following table shows the categories of outgoing mail during the past year:

Daily first class mail	28,385
Daily parcel post	11,352
Bulletins & special mailings	87,485
1951 Directory mailing	4,000
	<u>131,222</u>

More than 26,000 copies of the "Big Book" were distributed during the period between conferences and approximately 465,000 copies of A.A. pamphlets were mailed out. Of the latter figure, more than 62,000 were copies of the recent "Fortune" reprint.

Other highlights of General Service Office activity included:

1. Preparation of scrolls for heirs of Dr. Bob and Dr. Silkworth.
2. Issuance of Serenity Prayer wallet cards.
3. Release of new recording by Bill on Third Legacy.
4. Work with Trustees' committee on Literature.
5. Release of recording: "Dr. Bob's Last Major Talk".
6. Poll of Conference delegates regarding Lasker Award
7. Confirmation of policy on contributions from A.A. members.
No gift in excess of 1/10 per cent of the Foundation budget will be accepted from members. No contributions are accepted from non-A.A. sources.
8. Appointment of committee on "authoritative" translations.
9. Decision to charge \$1.00 for group directories ordered by individuals (Orders must clear through group secretary).
10. Decision to continue Bill's semi-annual appeal for funds "until this is no longer necessary."

(An outline of G.S.O. handling of incoming mail appears in the Appendix).

"IT'S A QUESTION OF LIVES THAT MAY BE LOST IF A.A. DOES NOT SURVIVE"

(Following the presentation on the work of the General Service Office and its importance to the survival of many among the "million who still don't know," the Conference voted to throw the session open for a discussion of means of getting adequate financial support for the Office.

(A number of key points were made: (a) Continued dependence upon personal appeals from Bill is not in the best interests of the Society; (b) the Reserve Fund of the Foundation should be increased to guard against possibly serious contingencies; (c) the Group Contribution Fund still owes the Reserve Fund of the Foundation \$24,000, "borrowed" in previous years.

(After inconclusive discussion, Bill was asked to comment on the general problem of getting the membership to support its service facilities. A digest-summary of his remarks follows).

"When it comes to this problem of asking this Society to support its own services, let us try to put ourselves in the other fellow's place.

"He is interested, first of all, in his own recovery, his own survival. Next, he is interested in his family and in what he can do for them after all his years of drinking. Next, he is likely to be interested in the fellow he is twelfth-stepping. Next, down the line, he is interested in his group and the place where it meets and the way meetings are run and so on.

"Now, that's the way things always will be, the way they always should be.

"In other words, it's only very slowly and very gradually that you are going to get this A.A. interested in even a local Intergroup or Central Office set-up, much less national and international headquarters of the society.

"In fact, it is only when he wakes up to discover that the local situation is becoming pretty chaotic---with newcomers not being looked after, with no suitable arrangements for hospitalization, with no adequate telephone facilities---that this A.A. finally begins to see the glimmer of a need for an Intergroup office.

"Finally, and laboriously, he and some of the other drunks in the area hire an office and sit a gal in it. So an Intergroup, or a Central Office, comes into being. But only after the need has been there for a long time, only after our friend and the other AAs have come to see a personal necessity for an Intergroup. They have to see that personal necessity, or nothing gets done.

"Three times in the history of Alcoholics Anonymous we have created services in advance of the time the average alcoholic could see the need for them.

"IT'S A QUESTION OF LIVES THAT MAY BE LOST IF A.A. DOES NOT SURVIVE"
(Continued)

"Many people thought back in 1939 that the book, 'Alcoholics Anonymous,' was not only heresy but the beginning of a big racket. They saw no use for it. They thought they were being asked to buy or contribute to something to fill a need that they simply could not see.

"The same thing happened when The Alcoholic Foundation was created. People began to fear that great sums of money would be involved, that our affairs would be under the control of some great bureaucratic board. They said, 'Let's not do this thing.' And some people even said: 'The Alcoholic Foundation is a menace to our future.'

"Not too many years ago, there were a lot of people who did not see the need for overall management of our public relations at the national level. These people couldn't imagine hundreds of groups writing in to the New York Office to get the benefit of our overall national experience. They couldn't foresee some of the problems that would develop.

"When the Grapevine was first set up as our national publication, again there were a lot of folks who simply could not see the need for a magazine of that type.

"We were dealing with ventures in prophecy!

"It was foreseeable six or eight years ago that there would be a need for a link between the Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation and the movement. We could see then that if we did not come up with the General Service Conference, or something like it, this movement would cave right in---in the middle.

"It was predicted that we would meet with complete indifference. People foresaw issues breaking out all over the country. They thought there would be a lot of politics. What they could not foresee was the need to strengthen the unity of our fellowship by transferring the Third Legacy of service to representatives of the society itself.

"We have to remember that most of our services are not visible to the average group. Take, for example, the prodigious work of public relations that has helped to preserve and protect us for many years. The average A.A. in the average group can't possibly have any conception of the importance of that work.

"Another thing we have to remember is that as ex-drunks, we have all had frightening personal problems to cope with. And the groups themselves have had problems. Now, those problems were visible. And, because they were visible, they seemed a lot more real than some of the problems The Trustees and the Headquarters Office have been wrestling with back here.

"IT'S A QUESTION OF LIVES THAT MAY BE LOST IF A.A. DOES NOT SURVIVE" (Cont.)

"There was a time, in the early days, when some people thought we were cluttering up this movement by trying to get people to consider the Twelve Steps. We don't have to worry about the Twelve Steps anymore. They are pretty well accepted by the Society today.

"The same problem came up when we began to set down our Twelve Traditions of group experience. People thought I was a little crazy when I began to set those traditions down in writing. But today the Traditions are pretty well accepted by the groups---although the average A.A. still isn't too sure what they're all about because he simply can't see them.

"Now, as to getting financial support for the services carried out back here, we might think of it in terms of an educational job, without too much pressure. We don't want to make any 'drives' for funds, in the usual sense of the term. But if delegates to this Conference can carry home an adequate picture of our services, if you can relate the operation of The Alcoholic Foundation to the functioning and survival of the whole movement, I don't think we are going to have too great a problem about getting the support we need to carry the message to the 'million who still don't know!' It's largely a question of using common horse sense and of doing first things first.

"Let's not be bashful about what we are doing, or what we need. Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole has to function or we fail. Our needs are pretty simple and pretty clear. Our big need has to do with survival. It's a question of survival for us. It's a question of lives that may be lost if A.A. does not survive.

"Right now, about half of the groups are carrying the load of the General Service Office and, in addition, making a gift to the guys and gals who aren't contributing anything.

"If we can get that story across where it will do some good back home, I don't think we will have to worry too much about getting real support for our Service office!"

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

Last year was critical for the survival of the "Grapevine" but the efforts of 1951 Conference delegates helped produce a 6,000-copy increase in circulation and put the magazine in the black for the year, the retiring "Grapevine" editor reported.

Current circulation is 29,600. An increase to 33,000, it was estimated by the publication staff, would enable the magazine to net approximately \$6,000 for the current fiscal year, ending March 31, 1953. It was noted that the accumulated operating losses of the "Grapevine" totalled \$27,918 on March 31, 1952.

Staff members emphasized that the bulk of the circulation increase during the past year was achieved during the four months immediately following the 1952 Conference and was definitely attributable to the "mild promotion" recommended by the delegates. How much of this circulation will be renewed is problematical.

The tenor of discussion from the floor was uniformly optimistic. Without exception, speakers emphasized that the problem of getting subscriptions to the "Grapevine" involved little more than "asking for them". Specific cases cited included:

1. In one group, the percentage of A.A.s subscribing to the magazine increased from 30% to 75% with minimum "promotion".
2. In another group 21 out of 22 regulars are subscribers; four copies are purchased for general group use; one meeting each month is based on material from the magazine.
3. In one state, "by just presenting facts and figures," a delegate reported getting 218 new subscriptions.
4. As the result of setting up a small booth at a regional conference, 61 subscriptions were obtained in two days.
5. In one large city, an active "family group" has been responsible for a large number of new subscriptions.

The possibility of having a "Grapevine chairman" in each group was suggested by several speakers. The "chairman" would be responsible not only for helping to get the magazine into the hands of as many A.A.s as possible, but would also help to develop editorial material.

Criticisms and suggestions, as well as editorial contributions, were invited by the new editor. Many groups, particularly the new ones, he noted, apparently were not aware that reports, articles or commentaries on A.A. would be welcome from their members.

COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE

As recommended by the first General Service Conference, the Trustees of The Alcoholic Foundation last Summer appointed a special Committee on Literature to review the material now being released by the General Service Office, to determine what type of material was needed by the Society and to suggest basic elements of policy for a national A.A. literature program. (In presenting its report, the Committee emphasized that it was concerned only with Foundation-approved literature).

The Committee's report covered five main points: (1) Functions of A.A. literature, (2) Suggested elements of policy, (3) Analysis of basic types of current literature, (4) Committee activities since the '51 Conference and (5) Literature needs today, based on requests from the groups.

FUNCTIONALLY, the Committee suggested, A. A. literature has five jobs: (1) To represent A.A. to the alcoholic who is still drinking; (2) To represent A.A. to the general public, including relatives, friends, and employers of alcoholics, and their medical and spiritual advisors; (3) To provide for the sound growth of the society by documenting, through material on the Traditions, the society's tested principles and practices; (4) To encourage and inspire the continuing interest of members, but only in terms of their own benefit and (5) To provide essential communication between the General Service Office and the groups.

POLICYWISE, these checkpoints were offered: A.A. literature should: (1) Meet clearly established needs and have Conference approval; (2) Be revised as needed to reflect the spiritual and physical growth of the movement; (3) Follow accepted editorial principles and practices and (4) Be standardized in format and design for maximum efficiency in printing, distribution & use.

The society actually has three basic types of literature, the Committee noted: literature that relates A.A. to the individual who seeks help; literature describing the movement, and literature on the structure of A.A., including the Conference.

Ten distinct projects were carried out by the Committee during the past year, the report showed. These included production of the new pamphlet, "A.A. for the Woman," the pictorial script for film strips on headquarters services, the 1951 Conference report, Interim reports from the Trustees to the delegates, preparation of the manuscript for a new pamphlet on "The Alcoholic Employee," material on the Traditions prepared by Bill, two recordings and two reproductions of the A.A. prayer.

Major literature projects for which a need has been expressed by the groups include the following: (1) Sponsorship pamphlet, (2) Pamphlet on "slips," (3) a standard "introduction to A.A." for use by groups which do not have access to booklets of this type now bearing the imprint of intergroup associations, (4) a brief history of A.A., (5) a revised folder on The Alcoholic Foundation, (6) revision of the Secretary's Handbook, (7) a New "Sedatives" pamphlet, (8) a new pamphlet on Medicine and A.A., (9) new visual material on services and (10) a full-scale writing project on which Bill is now working (See Page 20).

LOCAL GROUP PROBLEMS

Four main subjects were covered during the hour-long session on "Local Group Problems":

1. THE PROBLEM OF THE "EASY-DOES-IT" FELLOW WHO LOAFS AROUND THE CLUBHOUSE, STAYS SOBER BUT MAKES NO EFFORT TO SUPPORT HIMSELF.

After considerable comment from the floor, it seemed generally agreed that this is a problem that "tends to take care of itself." Criticism of the type of fellow involved may indicate that the critic is taking moral inventory of the wrong person, several speakers suggested. It may take time, one delegate reminded the Conference, but many apparent "phonies" eventually get their teeth into the A.A. program and it's a mistake to be overly concerned about the problem.

2. THE PROBLEM OF GETTING AN ACCURATE COUNT OF GROUP MEMBERSHIP, PARTICULARLY IN AREAS WHERE THERE IS CONSIDERABLE VISITING AMONG GROUPS.

A delegate from a large (275) group said a person is considered a member when he has 90 days of sobriety behind him...An Eastern delegate says his group issued cards asking people (a) if they had been dry 90 days or more, (b) if they would "consider themselves members and assume group responsibilities. Sixty persons "signed up," in place of the 50 expected...A Midwest delegate reports a census is taken once a year by his city's Central Committee to determine the "sober and active" members... A Far West delegate said his group does not count a person, even if sober, who has not been active for six months in the group...A delegate from the Southwest suggested a "short count" was sometimes made for practical financial reasons in reporting to the General Service Office.

3. THE PROBLEM OF NON-A.A.s WHO TEND TO DOMINATE A.A. GROUPS

Several speakers emphasized that A.A. in some areas owes its beginnings and present usefulness to helpful, generous non-A.A.s...but occasionally the clergy, politicians & others miss the point of A.A. and associate it with temperance or religious objectives. It was generally agreed, by delegates experienced in coping with this problem, that the best policy is a firm policy, that a forthright assertion of the unique characteristics of A.A. is the only sound approach. The alternative to this forthright approach in dealing with this type of non-A.A., according to one delegate, is a loss of interest, membership and groups. "You can't afford to be too gentle about the situation," he said. "In fact, sometimes you may have to speak harshly to these people."

4. THE PROBLEM OF JOINT ADMINISTRATION OF A.A. AND "CLUB" FACILITIES

The delegate who brought up this problem said that his group had recently acquired new quarters that were being used for meetings and as a "clubhouse." The members were discovering, he said, that the steering committee's time was now being consumed largely on petty administrative matters. It was generally agreed by delegates who spoke to this problem that unless "strictly A.A. group services" were divorced from problems involved in running a clubhouse, the steering committee would soon be spending seven-eighths of its time on "club" details.

CENTRAL AND INTERGROUP OFFICE SET-UPS

A number of delegates expressed interest in the problem of selecting effective "steering committees" for Intergroup or Central Office set-ups. One Conference member, expressing concern with the growing budget of his area intergroup set-up, felt that these increases might be due to the fact that the steering committee of seven persons changed every six months, reducing any sense of continued responsibility for the service office. Would it, he asked, be practical to establish a more-or-less permanent Board of Trustees to "control"--but not "run"--the set-up?

In general, the Conference seemed to feel that it would be a mistake to give any body of A.A.s the right to serve for long periods in any capacity---and that the principle of rotating group servants should be followed where intergroups are involved, too.

One Intergroup area reported that it operates with a Business Management Committee, with committee members rotating annually so that the board at all times has both "experienced" and "new" delegates on it. "We feel that a man who is a little tight with a nickel is a good man for a committee of this type," the delegate commented.

Another delegate reported an intergroup steering committee of five persons who serve 15 months apiece, the term being arranged so that one member of the committee is replaced every three months.

It was emphasized by the representative of still another intergroup set-up that his service committee concerned itself only with specific local services and never came between the local group and the General Service Office of The Alcoholic Foundation. Bulletins from the Foundation go direct to the local groups in his area, he said.

A provocative, if inconclusive, discussion followed the posing of this direct question: "What happens when a colored person comes to A.A.?" The following summarize the more representative answers:

1. "We look at the individual as an alcoholic, without regard to the color of his skin. There are a number of interracial groups in our area. Negroes are being hospitalized, as needed. We have faced no problems."
2. "We do not believe it would be 'safe' to have colored people attend our meetings; we do answer every 12th Step call (about 50 to date) and send members from our group to the one small colored group in the city."
3. "We believe this is a sectional, rather than a national issue".
4. "We seem to have difficulty getting colored people to understand alcoholism except as a moral issue or sin. We are willing to help but don't know what to do."
5. "We never attempt to segregate Negroes or other groups; as a result we have been able to help hundreds in our area."
6. "As recently as 1948, the Negro group was the only one in our city that contributed to The Alcoholic Foundation. They want help. We help them."

DEVIATIONS FROM TRADITIONS & RELATIONS WITH STATE & LOCAL COMMISSIONS

The first part of this session was devoted to an outline of "the Houston situation," involving a local group which had incorporated itself, as The Alcoholic Foundation of Texas, about six weeks period to the Conference. In their outline of the situation, both delegates from Texas reminded the Conference that the incorporation was "entirely legal" and that the Foundation name could be used.

Would it be possible to restrain the group from the use of the Foundation name, a delegate wanted to know. In a court of equity, yes, was the tentative answer from a lawyer-delegate, but the problem was complicated by the fact that the Foundation name had not been registered in the office of the Secretary of the State of Texas.

Other delegates suggested that judgment on the situation be withheld until results of the Houston action could be appraised. Some concern was expressed over the fact that the group involved was believed to have accepted substantial contributions of funds, some from outside sources.

Highlights of discussions on various traditions:

Fourth Tradition: Autonomy tradition does not preclude groups getting together to initiate new projects for their common good, even if older groups fail to provide "leadership."

Fifth Tradition (Primary purpose) Point was made that some people use this tradition to justify ostrich-like attitudes toward other phases of alcoholism. How far should the individual A.A. go in making this knowledge of alcoholism available in non-A.A. situations? Commenting on this and the Sixth ("no alliance") Tradition, Bill made the point that "If we insist on 100% anonymity at the level of press, radio, television and other media, practically no major problems are likely to arise." To deprive others of our experience might be both anti-social and ridiculous, Bill suggested.

The most important point developed during the discussion of "Relations with State and Local Commissions on Alcoholism" boiled down to a simple warning from a delegate who is also executive direction of a state commission.

"The A.A. who works with these groups should first get a clear definition of his responsibilities and then draw a line beyond which he will not go in breaking his anonymity. The important thing is to set up standards in the first place and let the people you are working with know what they can reasonably expect you, as an A.A., to do."

DEMONSTRATIONS OF DELEGATES' WORK WITH LOCAL COMMITTEES AND GROUPS

This panel discussion was suggested as a means of capitalizing the experience of delegates who had been outstandingly successful (or unsuccessful) in relaying the Third Legacy message back to their areas following the 1951 General Service Conference.

Here are four themes that were heard recurringly during the hour-long session:

1. PROPERLY HANDLED, THE THIRD LEGACY STORY CAN BE A "SHOT IN THE ARM" TO BASIC A. A. UNITY

The "Third Legacy" involves more than a mere review or outline of General Service Operations--or getting subscriptions for the "Grapevine," one delegate emphasized. It is a dramatic means of focusing the attention of area committeemen and group secretaries on the basic problem of unity within the groups--and among groups.

2. DELEGATES SHOULD NOT TRY TO DO THE REPORTING JOB ALONE

It is a mistake, most of the delegates agreed, to try to handle alone the job of reporting on General Service Conferences. The fullest possible participation of area committeemen should be encouraged and a definite sharing of responsibility should be agreed upon. In one or two cases, delegates reported that their committeemen had not followed through effectively. In most cases, however, delegates who felt the over-all effort in their territory had been reasonably successful were emphatic in their praise of work done by committeemen.

3. BE SURE COMMITTEEMEN GET THE REPORT FIRST

One of the most successful operations was reported by a delegate who stressed repeatedly the elaborate precautions taken to be sure committeemen in his area got the complete story before "casual" talks were made in his territory. This delegate pointed out that he did not rely exclusively upon report material supplied by the General Service Office. Special material was developed locally to fit area needs, he said. Its effectiveness was demonstrated in the case of the group that was about to be dislodged from its meeting place because it couldn't pay the rent. After the Third Legacy story had been presented to the group, it raised sufficient funds not only to satisfy its landlord but also to double its contribution to the General Service Office.

4. DON'T BE DISHEARTENED BY RESISTANCE OR MISUNDERSTANDING

A number of delegates testified that in some areas indifference amounting to apathy was the first reaction to the story of the Third Legacy. In nearly all cases, however, resistance to the story of A.A.'s national and international services is dwindling. If the group or individual is not interested in the story the first time around, "don't shove it at him," one Conference member advised. "After a while they'll begin to get in line. You'd be surprised what God can do."

NON-ALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

In his opening remarks to the conference, Chairman Smith explained how The Alcoholic Foundation came to have a Board of Trustees on which non-alcoholics are always in the majority:

"When The Alcoholic Foundation was formed, the handful of alcoholics who decided that this instrumentality was necessary believed that it would be in the best interests of their Society to have a majority of non-alcoholics as a balance-wheel on the Board of Trustees. At Bill's request, a corporation known as The Alcoholic Foundation was organized. The certificate of incorporation provided that a majority of the Board be non-alcoholics, and the balance alcoholics.

Mr. Smith said that he had felt for some time, "as this Society rapidly matures, that there is no further need for the presence of non-alcoholics on the Board. This, however, is an issue that this Conference, and the Conferences that will convene in the years ahead, must determine for themselves. The non-alcoholic members of the Board are here today only to serve this Conference. We serve at your pleasure, for your need, and to a man we are prepared to step down whenever you tell us that the need for our services has ended."

At the policy session on non-alcoholic trustees, Mr. Smith reiterated his view "that this Society can survive very effectively without non-alcoholic trustees."

When the matter was opened for discussion from the floor, delegate after delegate rose to report that groups in his territory had instructed him to vote for the retention of non-alcoholic trustees.

As one delegate phrased it: "The groups in my territory feel that the non-alcoholic trustees perform a very special service that we don't have the money to buy. They want the non-alcoholic trustees to continue to serve us without restrictions."

A motion to this effect was adopted unanimously and enthusiastically.

CONGRESSIONAL INCORPORATION

In presenting this subject for deliberation and advisory action by the Conference, Mr. Smith reviewed briefly the origin of suggestions that A.A. should be incorporated by an Act of Congress.

The Trustees first considered the subject seven or eight years ago, when A.A. first began to spread "at a very accelerated rate" and when a number of Alcoholics Anonymous groups and corporations were being formed throughout the country, some by persons who used the name for selfish purposes.

Several suggestions were made for "protecting" the A.A. name. One proposal was that A.A. be incorporated in every state of the Union, and "qualified" in two-thirds of the states. A detailed study was made of this possibility and counsel was retained to initiate the project. Doubts soon arose, however, as to the measure of protection this plan would afford if any one went ahead and used the name.

Of even deeper significance, Mr. Smith said, were the doubts expressed by Bill and others as to whether A.A., "as a faith and a way of life", really belonged in the field of incorporation

Legal counsel was thereupon discharged and the funds advanced to him were recovered in full.

"If we want to incorporate at all," Mr. Smith suggested, "it now appears that the sound approach would be through an Act of Congress." The fundamental purpose in even thinking of incorporation, he said, was simply to protect the name of A.A. and to prevent non-A.A. groups from using the name.

When the subject was opened up for discussion from the floor, a motion was soon made and seconded that, subject to consideration of the Trustees, steps be taken to incorporate the Society by an Act of Congress.

Whatever support may have existed for this motion was largely dissipated, however, by the quiet yet convincing remarks of the delegate who asked: "Can we incorporate a way of life? Can we incorporate a philosophy? Can we incorporate principles that were first presented to us nearly 2,000 years ago?" A.A., this delegate said, is "too broad and too deep" to fit the confines of incorporation.

Although there was full expression of diverging points of view for the remainder of the session, a motion to table the original motion was carried unanimously. The Conference had made it clear that it was not now ready to move forward toward Congressional incorporation.

Following this action, a motion was passed calling upon the Trustees to appoint a committee of five Conference delegates to study the problem.

TERMS OF OFFICE OF DELEGATES

Although this policy session resulted in a decision to take no action that would alter present provisions of two-year terms for Conference delegates, the discussion was one of the most stimulating and inspiring of the entire four-day meeting.

As significant, perhaps, as anything that happened at the 1952 Conference was the recurring affirmation of the delegates that the principle of rotation at all levels of A.A. affairs should be preserved and strengthened. No delegate even remotely suggested that the term of office of the present panel should be extended.

In addition to the need for constant emphasis on the principle of rotation, these factors were also discussed:

1. PRE-CONFERENCE TRAINING OF DELEGATES

Several delegates mentioned that programs were under way in their areas to begin "development" of future Conference delegates a year or two before the individuals involved would be called upon to serve. This is done, in several cases cited, by specifying that an area committee chairman shall be the "delegate-apparent" and work with the actual delegate for a year or two.

2. CONFERENCE SERVICE AS A UNIFYING FACTOR

It was noted with some emphasis that service as a delegate is one of the most important factors in preserving and strengthening the basic unity of the Society. Any measure that would slow up the rotation of delegates would, therefore, be a disservice to the unity of A.A.

Despite the apparent unanimity of opinion in support of a two-year term for delegates, a motion that would have put the Conference on record in favor of such a span of service was tabled before it could be put to a vote. This action was accompanied by a clear expression of Conference opinion that the Conference should not, in any way, usurp the prerogatives of the area committees and local groups.

In his comments on this subject, Bill suggested that in years to come the movement as a whole might see the desirability of slightly longer terms of office, "perhaps three years". He reminded the delegates that the Conference was still an experimental venture and that it was planned to review developments and assess experience at the end of four years of Conference operations. The fifth Conference, he suggested, might include some or all of the delegates from the four preceding Conferences, as a means of utilizing the total experience of all delegates who had served during the experimental period.

FAMILY GROUPS

More time was spent in reviewing and discussing the past, present and probable future status of so-called "family groups" than was devoted to any other item on the 1952 Conference agenda. An extra full session of the Conference was convened solely for the purpose of permitting expression from all delegates who wished to be heard on this topic. Recordings of the two meetings show that nearly 30 delegates were heard--a number of them rising to speak several times.

Here is how the two sessions on this provocative topic might be summarized:

1. FAMILY GROUPS ARE NOT A NEW DEVELOPMENT. Wives of the earliest members used to get together in Akron in the first days of the Society. The first "group", Bill said, was comprised of wives who met on the second floor of the 24th Street Clubhouse in New York City.
2. FAMILY GROUPS SEEM HERE TO STAY--AND ARE INCREASING RAPIDLY. A year-and-a-half ago, there were only about 50-to-70 groups. Now Bill and Lois know of more than 250. Urged by Bill, Lois and several other volunteers have attempted to serve as a "clearing house" for the expanding movement.
3. FAMILY GROUP REPRESENTATIVES HAVE AFFIRMED THEIR DISTINCT ENTITY. The family groups are filling a distinct need, according to the evidence from areas where the idea has taken hold, and the groups are not seeking to use the "A.A." name. As a movement with local groups in all parts of this country and in Canada, the non-alcoholics have their own committees and their own program. As now set up they do not impinge on A. A. and do not seek to do so.
4. DEVELOPMENT OF FAMILY GROUPS IS VIEWED SYMPATHETICALLY IN VIRTUALLY ALL AREAS. Only two delegates out of 77 came to the 1952 Conference with instructions from area committees that might be construed as critical of the family group movement.
5. REPORTS OF FAMILY GROUP DEVELOPMENT ARE CARRIED IN THE "GRAPEVINE," WHEN NEWSWORTHY. Historically, the "Grapevine," from its first issue, has carried news of non-A.A. happenings when they relate to the interests of A.A. readers, directly or indirectly. The Conference, in a special resolution, affirmed its support of this traditional "Grapevine" policy.
6. DELEGATES TO THE 1952 CONFERENCE APPROVE UNANIMOUSLY THE WORK THAT LOIS AND BILL HAVE DONE TO ENCOURAGE AND SUPPORT THE SOUND GROWTH OF THE FAMILY GROUP MOVEMENT. This sentiment, framed in a special resolution at the close of the final policy session, was adopted by an enthusiastic standing vote of all delegates.

LITERATURE---"BILL'S PROJECT"

When the General Service Conference of 1951 proved such a success, Bill told the delegates to this year's meeting, he began to ponder "what particular thing could I do that would be of the greatest service to the greatest number and to the longest future."

The result of his pondering, as he outlined it during the policy session on Foundation literature, is a five-year writing-and-research project designed to preserve and strengthen the unity of the Society and help it to reach out with increasing effectiveness to "the million who still don't know."

Briefly, the project involves these items:

1. Up-dating of the story section of the "Big Book" to provide a more truly representative cross-section of A.A. recovery stories.
(Delegates were urged to send in wire and tape recordings of actual talks, for consideration during revision of the book).
2. A new series of anecdotal analyses of the Twelve Traditions
3. A series of orderly, point-by-point essays on the Twelve Steps.
4. "A kind of a popular history of A.A. and its ideas of recovery, tradition and service.
5. A book on the application of A.A. philosophy to the "total problem of living."
6. A reference manual stating our total experience with the whole idea of service functions.

His new program for serving the Society means, Bill said, "that I will have to become a great deal of a recluse. Writing, for me, is a hard, arduous task. It will mean, too, that I won't be available for a long time to make those treasured visits to all parts of the A.A. world."

As he did last year, Bill reviewed with the delegates the financial arrangements under which he now works, reminding them that his living is derived from royalties on the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous." Should there be an increase in his royalties as a result of the writing project he has set for himself, Bill said, he would wish to take from them only "a good living," not necessarily the full royalties his writings may earn. As a matter of movement interest, Bill said, he hoped it would be agreeable if he had discretion over the disposition of his excess royalties---not for personal use, but for such matters as restitution to creditors and some provision for the future of General Service Office employees who now have no form of social security. (Bill's presentation was approved in its entirety, upon recommendation of the Conference Committee on Literature.)

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

The following summarizes various Conference Committee reports and recommendations acted upon at the closing session: (All recommendations approved unanimously).

COMMITTEE ON BOARD OF TRUSTEES

It was reported that the Committee had met and had discussed its responsibilities for the coming year but that no formal report was now in order.

COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA

Before recommending topics for next year's Conference agenda, the Committee will correspond with all other Conference Committees, with the Board of Trustees and with the General Service Office. Delegates were invited and urged to write to the Agenda committee with suggestions for next year's meeting.

COMMITTEE ON THE CONFERENCE REPORT

It was announced that an attempt would be made to get the first draft of the 1952 Conference report to all delegates within three weeks following the close of the Conference and prior to publication of the June "Grapevine," as requested by the delegates. A digest of "Conference Highlights" will also be mailed to all groups.

COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The following recommendations were made and approved:

1. That the Conference limit and define this Committee's responsibilities to cover only matters pertaining to the Conference itself.
2. That the Conference authorize this Committee to act for it in deciding questions of delegate representation, as well as such other matters as may properly be placed before it.
3. That terms of office for members of Conference Committees who are on the second panel should be extended to two years, in order to ensure a carry-over on each Committee of the previous year's experience. Also, your Policy Committee recommends that in the future, all new Conference Committee members should be elected for a term of two years.
4. That Conference Committee Chairman should be elected from the new members of the Conference.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS
(Continued)

5. That Conference Committee Secretaries should serve in an advisory capacity only, and should not be entitled to a Committee vote.
6. That third panel members should assemble next year one day prior to assemblage of the full Conference.
7. That the Third Legacy Pamphlet should be followed next year in determining delegate representation.
8. That the Policy Committee to be elected in 1954 consider the advisability of recommending an enlarged Panel for 1955.

COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE

The following recommendations were made and approved:

1. That the report of the Foundation's Committee on Literature, together with Bill's report of his proposed program of activity be approved.
2. That the following be incorporated on all literature published by the Works Publishing, Inc.: "Issued by Works Publishing, Inc., sole publishing agency of the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous. Approved by the General Service Conference of A.A."
3. That this conference reaffirm the stand taken by the 1951 Conference as follows: "This conference has no desire to review, edit, or censor non-Foundation material. Our object is to provide, in the future, a means of distinguishing Foundation literature from that issued locally or by non-A.A. interests."
4. That we approve the principle of paying professional writers on a fee basis when their employment has been authorized.
5. That we recommend the pamphlet "Sedatives" be given first priority in issuance of revisions of existing pamphlets.
6. That all suggestions made by delegates with reference to A.A. literature in general be turned over to the Foundation Committee on Literature for consideration and action, since the element of time precludes any action by the Conference Committee.
7. That facsimile reproductions of the Lasker Award be made available to all A.A. Groups in suitable form for framing where desired and requested.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS
(Continued)

COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

The following statement and recommendations were approved.

The Finance Committee of the 1952 General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous finds that while the Group Contribution Fund to support the General Service Office is showing marked improvement, there is nevertheless much yet to be done to assure an adequate regular income.

The present trend of improvement is attributable to the better understanding of General Service Office operations given to their groups by delegates to the first General Service Conference last year. This is not only gratifying in itself, but it is also a demonstration that groups will respond readily once they understand the functions of the General Service Office in serving the fellowship.

It is the belief that solution of the General Service Office's financial problems rests with the groups, and particularly with those groups not now contributing.

As means of further improving General Service Office's finances, both for the coming year and also looking toward permanent security, the Finance Committee submits these recommendations:

1. That the policy of seeking group contributions at the rate of \$2.00 a year for each member be continued in effect. It is suggested that groups provide for these contributions in monthly or quarterly budgets or schedules of expenditures.
2. That as a means of informing the groups, a simple summary of General Office Financial operations be prepared, showing current conditions, including the Group Fund's accumulated indebtedness of \$24,000 to the Alcoholic Foundation.
3. That delegates and state committeemen make a special effort to enlighten their groups in respect to the position of the General Service Office as the functional center of the A.A. movement, operating as the support of the existing membership and the bearer of the message to those alcoholics who still do not know.

"WE SEEK NOT COMPROMISE BUT CERTAINTY"

(Remarks of Mr. Bernard Smith at closing Conference session)

What we do here, and what we have done here, great as it has been, is not nearly or remotely as important, in my judgment, as the fact that we are here. For it is the existence and the preservation of this General Service Conference that is vital. The decisions we make here, important as they are, must in the last analysis, be subordinated to the greater significance of the existence of this Conference, for as long in the future as we can see, as a preserving arm of this great society of ours.

Actually, as I look back I feel the most important decisions that were here made were decisions to table decisions. To me that had a very, very profound implication. For here, unlike any political group, we seek not compromise but certainty. And in seeking certainty, it is frequently essential, as we found in the last few days, that motions be tabled because we were not yet sure.

I cannot reiterate too strongly my feeling that unless we are sure, unless we are certain, if there is yet time left to us to make a decision, I regard no decision as important as the willingness in an American society to postpone ultimate consideration. For again I like to reiterate those two words: We seek not compromise but certainty. If we can think of that concept, we will not fail, we will not err. We will be right and we will never, I trust, be wrong.

I cannot tell you how profoundly I was affected by the discussions that took place on the motion that related to the extension and the length of office of delegates. I am sure that everyone here enjoys serving as a delegate for as long as people would have him.

But complete and utter selflessness was implicit in the discussion, the feeling that each individual who spoke never thought of himself but thought of this great society, and therefore decided that far more important than whether he should continue to serve, was the consciousness that it was far better for him not to serve than to take the slightest risk with this great and delicate instrument of yours!

And I might say standing here as your chairman that it was impossible for me not to sense the complete spiritual interpretation of your thinking here. I can't tell you (because I stand here) how that has come across to me in waves. And no one can stand here without being deeply moved by this selfless and spiritual impenetration of this entire Conference.

You in A.A. have done something with the concept, "Love Thy Neighbor," which has removed it from the cliché. For you have staked out a specific neighborhood. You have found it possible to create a neighborhood within which to work, within which to give full meaning and potency to words that, unfortunately, to a large degree in common parlance, have lost their full significance.

"WE SEEK NOT COMPROMISE BUT CERTAINTY"
(Continued)

Out of the depth of your suffering, you have been given the light to see how black was the darkness from which you emerged, and to feel for everyone who still blunders along in that darkness, and what is more important, to do something about it. You in your own way have found that man is not a lonely, friendless creature, tossing helplessly about in a hostile world. You here in A.A. have found how deep are the roots of the wellspring of human love and friendship. And those roots can be tapped and the world can look upon you who sit here, and upon the groups all over this country, as evidence that human love and human friendship and human decency is still possible in this world of ours.

I have always found it difficult to know what A.A. is, how we can define A.A. It is probably the most elusive thing in history. It is something more than a movement. And yet not an order. It is a faith and yet not quite a religion. It is a society and yet not an organization.

For you have founded a society that is not divorced from life but has invigorated it and given it meaning. It is not removed from the Church but you have supplemented it, the Church, with an extra spire in your hearts that lifts just a little higher toward the heavens.

We are not free in one sense. We are bound by a faith that has succeeded in making us free for real, creative activity. We are dedicated to a single purpose, energized by a common need and dignified by human decency and humility.

We have learned that the spiritual can take hold of our material world and completely transform it. For A.A. stands before the world as living proof and evidence that in this industrial, mechanized, materialistic world of ours, Man need no longer cower in the shadows but, functioning effectively as an economic and social being, walk the earth fearlessly and erect in the sunlight before his God.

"WE FACE THE SUNRISE IN HIGH HOPE"
(Closing Remarks)

You share with me, I know, the thought that the closing hours of this Conference bring with them a deep and joyous realization - the realization that at last we are surely on the high road that stretches straight out toward our future; toward, we trust, an everlasting sunrise. We face the sunrise in high hope, with a confidence that is a perfect surety, and with our hearts full of unspeakable gratitude - gratitude to the Father of lights, Who has delivered us out of our bondage, gratitude to friends through whose hearts He has enabled this miracle to be worked, and gratitude to each other.

This, too, is an hour that will ever stir memory. With me, perhaps more than most, the wellsprings of memory are at flood tide. I think of a psychiatrist at Zurich, Switzerland, who had a patient, an American businessman - treated him a year. The patient thought greatly of his psychiatrist, none other than the famous Dr. Jung. The patient thought he was well, but on leaving the doctor, he soon found himself drunk. So he returned to Dr. Jung, who yet unknowing to this day, is certainly one of the founders of our Society. Dr. Jung said to this patient, "Unless you have a spiritual experience, there is nothing that can be done. You are too much committed to alcoholism to be saved in any other way."

Our friend thought it was a hard sentence, but like many of us since, he began to seek such an experience. He found it in the confines of the Oxford Group, an evangelical movement of that time. He sobered at once. There he found the grace to achieve his release. It was then called to his attention that a friend of his was about to be committed for alcoholism to an asylum in Vermont. Together with some other "Groupers," he interceded. The result was "Ebby," who first brought the essentials of recovery to me.

Meanwhile, there was a Jesuit Father, Ed Dowling, laboring among his flock, lame and relatively obscure. He, too, was to light a candle for A.A.

There was a nun, Sister Ignatia of Akron, who was to become the companion of Dr. Bob, who as you know, was the prince of our Twelfth Steppers. She, too, was to light a candle for us.

Even Saint Francis of Assisi, holding for the principle of corporate poverty, had lit a candle for A.A. So had William James, the father of modern psychology, whose book, "The Varieties of Religious Experience", had such a profound influence upon us. He had lit a candle for Alcoholics Anonymous. And no candle was to be brighter than that of Dr. William D. Silkworth, who was to tell us of the nature of our illness and counsel thousands on the road to freedom.

Then, too, there were to be couriers to all the world. Harry Emerson Fosdick, Fulton Oursler of Liberty. Jack Alexander and Curtis Bok, the owner of The Saturday Evening Post. They were to become couriers indeed. They, too, were to light candles for Alcoholics Anonymous.

"WE FACE THE SUNRISE IN HIGH HOPE"
(Continued)

Back there in the summer of 1934, the alcoholics of the world felt as hopeless as ever. Yet, as you now see, a table was being prepared in the presence of our ancient enemy, John Barleycorn. Candles were already upon it, meat and drink was there, but the guests had not arrived.

Then came two or three guests and they partook. The spark that was to become Alcoholics Anonymous was struck. Then ensued our period of flying blind, at the end of which, about 1937 or 1938, we realized that indeed a table had been prepared in the presence of our enemy, and that the candles upon that table might one day shine around the world to touch every distant beachhead of alcoholic disaster. There were more years of travail in that pioneering time which ended in 1941 with the advent of the Post article. Meanwhile, our book of experience, Alcoholics Anonymous, had appeared. No longer need we travel in person. The message could be taken through those printed pages to distant ones who suffered. Our recovery program was really complete.

Then came the test whether our growing groups could live and work together, whether the enormous explosive content of our fellowship would find in our principles of recovery a sufficient containing power to hold us in unity. In that ensuing period of adolescence, we realized that we of Alcoholics Anonymous must hang together or indeed we would hang separately.

It was during that exciting and sometimes frightening experience that the Tradition of Alcoholics Anonymous was forged. Years after, at Cleveland, in 1950, this body of Tradition was established by our fellowship as the traditional platform upon which our society intended to stand and to which it would commit our destiny.

No body of law was this Tradition. A set of principles, infused with the spirit of our 12 Steps of recovery and enshrined in the heart of each of us -- that would be our greatest protection, we thought, from any blows with which the outside world might assail us and our protection from any temptations to which we might be subjected within. So grew the Tradition of Alcoholics Anonymous.

In our period of infancy and in adolescence this Society also discovered that it had to function. This General Service Conference crowns that long process of discovery by which we have learned how we can best act to carry the A.A. message to those who still suffer. The advent of this Conference in full strength will indeed mark a great day in the annals of Alcoholics Anonymous.

For me, it marks a time when I must shift from activity to reflection and meditation. I must now take up the task of acting as your scrivener to record the experience of these marvelous years just past. I realize that I shall be but a reflector of you all - a recorder only. I hope that this task will be completed; that it will be useful and pleasing to you - and pleasing to God.

My heart is too full to say more - excepting "au revoir".

FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

INDEX

Summary of Financial Operations		- Exhibit A-1
The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	- Balance Sheet	- Exhibit A-2
	- Income Statement	- Exhibit B
Works Publishing, Inc.	- Balance Sheet	- Exhibit C
	- Income Statement	- Exhibit D
The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	- Balance Sheet	- Exhibit E
	- Income Statement	- Exhibit E
Consolidated	- Balance Sheet	- Exhibit F
	- Income Statement	- Exhibit F
Notes to Financial Statements		- Exhibit G

It being one of the purposes of the General Service Conference to spread the knowledge of and responsibility for the functioning of the General Headquarters, a brief statement of the corporate organization is necessary to a proper understanding of the attached statements.

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC. is a membership corporation whose general purpose is the rehabilitation of chronic alcoholics. This corporation owns all the outstanding stock of WORKS PUBLISHING, INC., whose functions are the publication and distribution of approved books and pamphlets, and the operation of the Headquarters Office. The Foundation also owns the beneficial interest in the net assets and income of THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC., whose functions are the publication and distribution of our monthly magazine.

The attached statements have been prepared by our independent certified public accountant. The consolidated statements (Exhibit "F") give a picture of the overall financial condition and the results of operations for the year. Notes explaining certain items in the statements are set forth in Exhibit "G".

SUMMARY OF FINANCIAL OPERATIONS

<u>The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.</u>	<u>1951</u>	<u>1950</u>
(1) Group Contributions	\$97,586	\$76,536
Expenses - General Service Headquarters . . .	<u>97,604</u>	<u>89,390</u>
<u>Deficit</u>	18	12,854
 <u>NOTE:</u> \$24,000 remains unpaid to A. F. Reserve Fund for previous advances to make up deficits in group contributions		
(2) Income - Reserve Fund		
Dividends, Works Publishing, Inc.	15,000	15,000
Interest on Savings Accounts	<u>1,029</u>	<u>849</u>
	16,029	15,849
Expenses, grants etc.	<u>7,717</u>	<u>16,904</u>
<u>Increase or (Decrease)</u>	8,312	(1,055)
 SUMMARY		
Increase or (Decrease), all Funds	9,053	(13,569)

(During 1951, contributions etc. for the 1951 General Service Conference totalled \$11,314, including a \$2,500 grant from the A.F. Reserve Fund. Expenses were \$13,246, leaving a deficit of \$932.)

<u>Works Publishing, Inc.</u>	<u>1951</u>	<u>1950</u>
Gross Receipts	94,228	85,160
Total Expenses	<u>59,068</u>	<u>65,185</u>
<u>Net Income</u>	35,160	19,975
Dividends Paid to A.F. Reserve Fund	<u>15,000</u>	<u>15,000</u>
<u>Balance</u>	20,160	4,975

<u>A. A. Grapevine, Inc.</u>	<u>1951</u>	<u>1950</u>
Gross Receipts	74,124	61,100
Total Expenses	<u>73,530</u>	<u>69,094</u>
<u>Net Income or (Loss)</u>	594	(7,994)

NOTE: \$13,660 remains unpaid to Reserve Fund for loans in prior years.

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.COMPARATIVE BALANCE SHEETDECEMBER 31, 1951 AND 1950

	<u>December 31, 1951</u>		<u>December 31, 1950</u>	
<u>ASSETS</u>				
GROUP FUND				
Cash in bank	\$ 10,430.55		\$ 10,422.27	
U.S. Savings Bonds	37.50		37.50	
Due from Works Publishing, Inc.		\$ 10,468.05	129.75	\$ 10,589.52
CONFERENCE FUND				
Cash in bank	3,983.14			
Due from Group Fund	78.00			
Due from General Fund			185.00	
Due from Works Publishing, Inc.	69.65	4,130.79	196.00	381.69
GENERAL FUND				
Cash in commercial account	15,175.59		14,846.46	
Cash in savings accounts	51,029.02		44,144.04	
Deposit with airline	425.00		425.00	
Prepaid expense	34.62			
(a)Advances to Group Fund	24,000.00		24,000.00	
Investments - Works Publishing, Inc.	500.00		500.00	
Investment in and advances to The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	13,661.00	104,825.23	13,661.00	97,576.50
<u>Total Assets</u>		<u>119,424.07</u>		<u>108,547.71</u>
<u>LIABILITIES</u>				
GROUP FUND				
Due Conference Fund	78.00			
(a)Due General Fund	24,000.00		24,000.00	
(b)Due Works Publishing, Inc.	9,861.75	33,939.75	10,043.39	34,043.39
CONFERENCE FUND				
Deferred income - 1952 Conference		3,031.50		
GENERAL FUND				
Due Conference Fund			185.00	
Due Works Publishing, Inc.			919.35	1,104.35
<u>Total Liabilities</u>		<u>36,971.25</u>		<u>35,147.74</u>
PRINCIPAL OF FUNDS				
- Group Fund - deficit	(23,471.70)		(23,453.87)	
Conference Fund	1,099.29		340.19	
General Fund	104,825.23	82,452.82	96,513.65	73,399.97
<u>Total Liabilities and Principal</u>		<u>119,424.07</u>		<u>108,547.71</u>

Parentheses denote red figures.

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC.
COMPARATIVE INCOME STATEMENT
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1951 and 1950

	<u>1951</u>	<u>1950</u>
A.A. GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND		
Contributions received	\$ 97,585.84	\$ 76,536.16
(c) General Headquarters expenses	97,603.67	89,389.92
Excess of Expense	<u>(17.83)</u>	<u>(12,853.76)</u>
GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE FUND		
Subscriptions received - 1951		
Conference	\$ 10,100.23	\$ 190.00
Sales of pamphlets, film strips, etc.	1,362.86	191.69
Grant from General Fund - contra	1,601.99	898.01
	13,065.08	1,279.70
Office expenses, postage, etc.	1,360.09	852.22
Pre-Conference travel	1,937.57	
Delegates' travel	1,777.14	
Rooms, meals, meeting expenses	3,425.18	
"Third Legacy" pamphlet cost	1,550.00	87.29
Projector slides and film strips	1,356.00	
Secretarial salary	900.00	939.51
Excess of Income	<u>759.10</u>	<u>340.19</u>
GENERAL FUND		
Dividends - Works Publishing, Inc.	15,000.00	15,000.00
Interest on savings accounts	1,029.02	849.15
	16,029.02	15,849.15
Rent	1,200.00	1,153.36
(d) General Headquarters travel	783.77	2,671.89
(e) Cost of Trustees' Meetings	2,041.79	1,303.09
Additions to Secretary's Handbook	807.54	1,905.50
Legal, accounting and miscellaneous	1,282.35	427.65
Grant to Conference Fund - contra	1,601.99	898.01
(f) Gift to M. R. Burger		3,871.70
(g) European travel		3,742.74
(h) Fidelity bond - three years	7,717.44	930.77
Excess of Income (Expense)	<u>8,311.58</u>	<u>16,904.71</u>
		<u>(1,055.56)</u>
ALL FUNDS COMBINED		
Total Income	126,715.64	93,665.01
Total Expense	117,662.79	107,234.14
Excess of Income (Expense)	<u>9,052.85</u>	<u>(13,569.13)</u>

Parentheses denote red figures.

WORKS PUBLISHING, INC.
COMPARATIVE BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1951 AND 1950

	<u>December 31, 1951</u>		<u>December 31, 1950</u>	
<u>ASSETS</u>				
Cash on hand and in banks		\$15,488.84		\$ 6,445.88
Accounts receivable:				
(b)The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	\$ 9,861.75		\$10,962.74	
Trade Customers and others				
(after reserve of \$1,161.06				
in 1951 and \$1,302.52 in				
1950)	<u>3,182.43</u>	13,044.18	<u>5,890.34</u>	16,853.08
(i)Inventories		41,526.24		24,387.85
Book plates, equipment,				
copyrights, and goodwill		<u>1.00</u>		<u>1.00</u>
<u>Total Assets</u>		<u>70,060.26</u>		<u>47,687.81</u>
<u>LIABILITIES AND CAPITAL</u>				
Accounts payable	4,856.43		2,190.74	
Accrued royalties	2,107.33		2,396.10	
Other deferred and accrued items	<u>381.55</u>		<u>545.65</u>	
<u>Total Liabilities</u>		7,345.31		5,132.49
Capital Stock	500.00		500.00	
Accumulated earnings, after				
deduction of dividends of				
\$15,000.00 in each year	<u>62,214.95</u>	<u>62,714.95</u>	<u>42,055.32</u>	<u>42,555.32</u>
<u>Total Liabilities and Capital</u>		<u>70,060.26</u>		<u>47,687.81</u>

WORKS PUBLISHING, INC.

COMPARATIVE INCOME STATEMENT

YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1951 AND 1950

	<u>1951</u>		<u>1950</u>	
NET SALES				
Books	\$62,042.31		\$60,567.02	
Pamphlets	26,940.33		22,517.76	
Records	1,918.93		259.70	
Other	3,326.42	\$94,227.99	1,815.81	\$85,160.29
COST OF SALES				
Opening inventory	24,387.85		16,138.96	
Purchases	45,309.77		39,451.85	
	69,697.62		55,590.81	
Less: Closing inventory	41,526.24		24,387.85	
	28,171.38		31,202.96	
Packing supplies	1,567.73		695.14	
Royalty expense	13,138.76	42,877.87	16,366.70	48,264.80
GROSS PROFIT FROM SALES		51,350.12		36,895.49
OPERATING EXPENSES				
Office Expenses:				
Salaries	61,227.60		56,322.84	
Postage and express	9,851.26		10,270.02	
Stationery and office supplies	3,285.45		3,016.23	
Rent and electricity	11,009.26		9,620.53	
Telephone and telegraph	2,270.00		2,159.72	
Payroll taxes and insurance	2,123.52		2,058.35	
General Headquarters printing	4,253.16		4,265.55	
Office equipment	5,959.25		4,871.79	
General office expenses	6,523.39		5,113.37	
Total Office Expenses	106,502.89		97,698.40	
(c) Less: Portion payable by The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	97,603.67	8,899.22	89,389.92	8,308.48
Other Expenses:				
(j) Salary			2,700.00	
Promotion	381.79		416.88	
(k) Bedford Hills expenses	3,260.69		3,379.61	
Accounting fees	3,000.00		1,000.00	
Taxes, other than payroll	250.06		117.71	
Provision for loss on doubtful accounts receivable			843.14	
Books donated to Gt. Britain Book Publishing Committee	398.73	7,291.27	154.24	8,611.58
Total Operating Expenses		16,190.49		16,920.06
NET INCOME FOR YEAR		35,159.63		19,975.43

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.

COMPARATIVE BALANCE SHEET

DECEMBER 31, 1951 AND 1950

	December 31, 1951	December 31, 1950
<u>Assets</u>		
Cash	\$ 9,982.81	\$ 2,432.83
Accounts receivable	1,788.00	187.80
Printing and mailing following issue	3,365.28	4,900.00
Inventory of mailing and office supplies	1,334.41	1,405.15
Prepaid rent	400.00	400.00
Furniture and equipment, less depreciation	4,614.85	4,777.95
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>21,485.35</u>	<u>14,103.73</u>
<u>Liabilities</u>		
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ 3,553.35	\$ 5,118.83
(1)Deferred subscription income	33,282.67	25,565.51
Advances by The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.	13,660.00	13,660.00
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>50,496.02</u>	<u>44,344.34</u>
<u>Capital and Deficit</u>		
Capital stock	1.00	1.00
Deficit from operations	(29,011.67)	(30,241.61)
<u>Deficit in Capital</u>	<u>(29,010.67)</u>	<u>(30,240.61)</u>
<u>Total Liabilities Less Deficit</u>	<u>21,485.35</u>	<u>14,103.73</u>

COMPARATIVE INCOME STATEMENT

(m) FISCAL YEARS ENDED MARCH 31, 1952 AND 1951

	March 31, 1952	March 31, 1951
<u>Income</u>		
Subscription income earned	\$46,209.38	\$35,343.06
Other sales	27,914.98	25,757.17
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>\$74,124.36</u>	<u>\$61,100.23</u>
<u>Expenses</u>		
Editorial and printing:		
Printing	26,994.80	27,359.65
Mailing	9,223.44	7,367.21
Salaries	9,790.16	8,466.80
Rent, telephone and other	2,889.24	3,064.23
	48,897.64	46,257.89
Circulation and business:		
Salaries	12,553.07	11,328.19
Postage and office supplies	6,088.48	5,935.46
Promotion, rent and other	5,991.26	5,572.68
	24,632.81	22,836.33
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>73,530.45</u>	<u>69,094.22</u>
<u>Income (Loss) from Operations</u>	<u>593.91</u>	<u>(7,993.99)</u>
(n)Uncollected bulk sales 3-31-51		1,238.35
<u>Net Income (Expense) for Year</u>	<u>593.91</u>	<u>(6,755.64)</u>

Parentheses denote red figures.

THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION, INC. AND WHOLLY OWNED SUBSIDIARIESWORKS PUBLISHING, INC. AND THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.COMPARATIVE CONSOLIDATED BALANCE SHEETDECEMBER 31, 1951 AND 1950

	<u>1951</u>	<u>1950</u>
<u>Assets</u>		
Cash on hand and on deposit	\$106,089.95	\$ 78,291.48
U.S. Savings Bonds	37.50	37.50
Accounts receivable, less reserve	4,970.43	6,078.14
Inventories	41,526.24	25,793.00
Deferred charges	5,559.31	5,725.00
Furniture and equipment, less reserves	4,615.85	4,778.95
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>162,799.28</u>	<u>120,704.07</u>
<u>Liabilities</u>		
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ 8,721.68	\$ 7,528.78
Accrued royalties	2,107.33	2,396.10
Deferred income:		
Subscriptions to "Grapevine"	33,282.67	25,565.51
Subscriptions to 1952 Conference	3,031.50	
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>47,143.18</u>	<u>35,490.39</u>
<u>Net Worth</u>		
Balance, January 1, 1951	\$85,213.68	
Net Income for Year	<u>30,442.42</u>	
Balance, December 31	<u>115,656.10</u>	<u>85,213.68</u>
<u>Total Liabilities and Net Worth</u>	<u>162,799.28</u>	<u>120,704.07</u>

CONSOLIDATED INCOME STATEMENTYEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1951

(m)		
Income from sales, subscriptions, etc.	\$168,788.73	
Cost of sales	<u>92,421.84</u>	
Gross profit from sales		\$ 76,366.89
Interest received on savings accounts		1,029.02
Accounts receivable adjustment (The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. March 31, 1951) - non-recurring		1,238.35
Group contributions for General Headquarters Expenses		<u>97,585.84</u>
<u>Total Income</u>		<u>176,220.10</u>
Operating expenses	144,934.79	
Net cost (1951) of 1951 General Service Conference	<u>842.89</u>	
<u>Total Expenses</u>		<u>145,777.68</u>
<u>Net Income for Year (see above)</u>		<u>30,442.42</u>

NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

- (a) Unpaid balance of amounts advanced to supplement Group contributions for payment of General Headquarters expenses.
- (b) December General Headquarters expenses, reimbursed in January
- (c) General Headquarters office expenses are paid by Works Publishing, Inc., which assumes as its share of such expenses 10% of its sales of books and pamphlets. In the following month the balance of General Headquarters expenses is repaid to Works by the Foundation out of the Group Fund.
- (d) Transportation and hotel costs of Bill and members of Headquarters staff on authorized visits to regional conferences, dinners, etc., less amounts reimbursed by groups visited.
- (e) Expenses of quarterly Trustees' meetings, including travel and hotel costs of out-of-town Trustees.
- (f) Balance of gift of \$3,750. plus medical expenses up to \$2,000, authorized by the Board of Trustees upon her retirement in 1949.
- (g) Bill and Lois' trip in 1950 visiting A.A. Groups in Denmark, England, France, Holland, Ireland, Norway, Scotland and Sweden.
- (h) Cost of \$25,000 bond covering all Trustees and General Headquarters Staff.
- (i) At December 31, 1951 includes new printing of 48,500 copies of the A.A. book.
- (j) Salary of Treasurer, discontinued September 30, 1950.
- (k) Office expenses and entertainment of visitors to home of Bill and Lois.
- (l) The income from each subscription is spread equally over the months to its expiration. Deferred subscription income represents that portion of all subscriptions applicable to future issues.
- (m) Because figures on the operations of The Grapevine for the quarter ended March 31, 1950 are not available, no income statement of that corporation can be prepared for the twelve months ended December 31, 1950. In order that comparative operating results might be submitted, therefore, Exhibit "E" reflects the operations for the two most recent fiscal years. The operations of The Grapevine for the twelve months ended December 31, 1951 resulted in net income of \$1,229.94, which figures are, of course, used in preparing the consolidated income statement presented in Exhibit "F".
- (n) A non-recurring item arising from the transfer of accounts receivable for monthly bulk sales from a memorandum accounting to the general books.

Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.
Contributions by State
Year 1951

GROUPS			GROUPS		
	<u>Contributing</u>	<u>Listed</u>		<u>Contributing</u>	<u>Listed</u>
Alabama	21	28	Nebraska	23	32
Arizona	11	31	Nevada	3	6
Arkansas	23	40	New Hampshire	11	18
California	268	438	New Jersey	61	116
Colorado	20	41	New Mexico	13	21
Connecticut	27	51	New York	150	269
Delaware	7	10	North Carolina	45	82
District of Columbia	3	6	North Dakota	8	22
Florida	60	88	Ohio	123	284
Georgia	16	35	Oklahoma	28	42
Idaho	6	16	Oregon	22	44
Illinois	50	283	Pennsylvania	85	161
Indiana	58	90	Rhode Island	8	20
Iowa	47	71	South Carolina	21	43
Kansas	24	38	South Dakota	14	22
Kentucky	15	47	Tennessee	16	34
Louisiana	14	27	Texas	96	164
Maine	16	36	Utah	15	37
Maryland	27	41	Vermont	11	19
Massachusetts	74	121	Virginia	36	61
Michigan	94	167	Washington	45	71
Minnesota	37	59	West Virginia	22	43
Mississippi	13	26	Wisconsin	58	98
Missouri	30	57	Wyoming	9	15
Montana	9	22			
			Alaska	4	9
			Canada	198	399
			Foreign	13	216
			Hospitals	11	82
			Internationalists	8	71
			Prisons	20	133

14 Special Contributions from Groups collectively.

SUMMARY OF OPERATIONS

THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.

	<u>Fiscal Years Ended</u>		<u>Fore cast</u>
	<u>March 31st</u>		<u>Fiscal year</u>
	1951	1952	1953
Total circulation - end of year	22,734.00	29,256.00	33,000.00
<u>Total income</u>			
Individual subscriptions	36,600.70	46,209.38	55,000.00
Bulk sales to Groups	25,762.07	27,914.98	30,000.00
	<u>62,362.77</u>	<u>74,124.36</u>	<u>85,000.00</u>
Operating Expenses			
Printing	27,359.65	26,994.80	30,000.00
Mailing	7,367.21	9,223.44	10,500.00
Salaries	19,794.99	22,343.23	23,500.00
Office expenses	14,596.56	14,968.98	15,000.00
	<u>69,118.41</u>	<u>73,530.45</u>	<u>79,000.00</u>
Net Income or (loss)*	<u>(6,755.64)</u>	<u>593.91</u>	<u>6,000.00</u>
Unpaid Loans from the Alcoholic Foundation, Inc. (Reserve Fund)	13,660.00	13,660.00	7,000.00
Accumulated Operating (loss)*	(28,512.81)	(27,918.90)	(22,000.00)

*Parentheses indicate losses.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION

PERCENTAGE BY STATE AND PROVINCES

State	A.A. Pop.	G.V. Subs.	Per Cent	State	A.A. Pop.	G.V. Subs.	Per Cent
Alabama	1,453	313	21.6%	New York	7,715	3,047	39.5%
Arizona	471	178	37.8%	North Carolina	1,684	547	32.5%
Arkansas	775	276	34.3%	North Dakota	389	115	29.5%
California	16,550	3,130	18.9%	Ohio	9,167	1,371	15. %
Colorado	728	308	42.3%	Oklahoma	1,169	521	44.6%
Connecticut	1,179½	369	31.3%	Oregon	654	258	39.4%
Delaware	353	83	23.5%	Pennsylvania	3,221	1,191	37. %
District of Col.	400	313	78.2%	Rhode Island	259	119	46. %
Florida	2,328	848	36.4%	South Carolina	917	296	32.2%
Georgia	1,037	175	16.3%	South Dakota	542	153	28.2%
Idaho	329	154	46.6%	Tennessee	802	154	19.2%
Illinois	6,571	1,214	18.4%	Texas	4,135	1,336	32.3%
Indiana	1,902	704	37. %	Utah	840	177	21. %
Iowa	2,038	534	26.2%	Vermont	313	173	55.2%
Kansas	1,080	372	34.4%	Virginia	1,664	517	31.1%
Kentucky	738	238	32.2%	Washington	1,250	559	44.7%
Louisiana	905	152	16.9%	West Virginia	850	319	37.4%
Maine	747	218	28.2%	Wisconsin	2,225	596	26.8%
Maryland	709	334	47.1%	Wyoming	128	53	41.4%
Massachusetts	2,487	1,071	43. %				
Michigan	4,489	1,028	24.1%		CANADA		
Minnesota	2,942	681	23.2%				
Mississippi	701	204	29. %	Alberta	361	83	23. %
Missouri	2,090	643	30.7%	British Columbia	1092	508	46.5%
Montana	377	82	21.7%	Manitoba	347	125	36. %
				New Brunswick	810	87	10.7%
Nebraska	469	153	32.6%	Newfoundland	47	6	12.8%
Nevada	186	60	32.2%				
New Hampshire	402	132	32.8%	Nova Scotia	605	105	17.3%
New Jersey	2,323	911	39.2%	Ontario	2,159	947	43.8%
New Mexico	329	128	38.8%	Prince Edward			
				Island	65	4	6.2%
				Quebec	1,155	184	15.9%
				Saskatchewan	453	142	31.3%

HANDLING OF DAILY MAIL
AT GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE

Mail at our P. O. Box 459 is picked up and brought back to the mail room where it is opened. The contents of each envelope are stapled together and stamped with a date and routing stamp and then given to the Senior General Secretary.

The Senior Secretary then classifies the mail and routes it into the proper channels. A list of (a) contributions to the General Service Fund, (b) orders and (c) payments is typed, and the amount totalled. The Senior Secretary keeps a carbon copy of this list, and sends the original to the bookkeeping department along with the orders, payments and contributions.

In Bookkeeping, these orders, contributions and payments are checked against the typed list. The contributions are then arranged in geographical alphabetical order and the name of the sender, together with the address and group name, is entered on a posting slip showing the amount and date. Each slip is given a folio number, which is also stamped on the back of the correspondence. When the information has been posted on the individual group contribution record, the posting slip and correspondence are sent to the Kardex clerk, who checks the information against the group records.

After the records check, a "thank you" card is typed out for each one and then sent with the slip and correspondence to the correspondence Secretary who looks after that area. Each secretary gets the card, slip and correspondence for all the groups in her territory. She signs the cards and initials the slips, which are then returned to the Bookkeeping Department for filing. The Secretary then answers the letters. Every day, each Secretary puts the letters she has answered along with the carbon copies of her replies in a folder which is circulated throughout the office so that the letters can be read by all the Secretaries.

In Bookkeeping, the orders and payments are separated and charge orders are arranged in geographical order, while cash orders are put in chronological order with the "rushes" on top. Orders that come in letter-form are written up on order blanks, the figures are checked, and corrections made, if necessary, on the orders. Each order is then assigned a number, in duplicate, so that the correspondence is then distributed to the Secretaries responsible for it. The amounts of cash orders are posted to the Sales Journal; charge orders are checked for credit standing; new ledger cards are made for new group charges. After shipping postage has been added, the amounts are posted to ledger cards and the Sales Journal.

Payments are posted to the group accounts and deposited in the bank along with the monies from the orders and contributions.

Labels are typed for all orders and sent from the Bookkeeping Department to the Shipping Department. "Rush" orders remain on top and the rest are arranged in chronological order. The Shipping Department makes up the orders and sends them parcel post, unless otherwise specified. Parcel post regulations limit packages in zones #1 and #2 to 40 pounds, and packages going outside these zones are 20 pounds.

HANDLING OF DAILY MAIL

(Continued)

Appeals for help are classified and if a request comes from someone interested in an alcoholic, a letter is written to the alcoholic enclosing literature and telling him how to contact A.A. in his own town if we have a record of a group there. A carbon copy of our reply is sent to the person who wrote us along with a covering letter.

If the request comes from an alcoholic, an A.A. Secretary replies, telling how to contact the nearest group and inviting the alcoholic to correspond with us here.

Requests for information regarding Alcoholics Anonymous from doctors, social workers, priests, ministers, and other interested persons are answered by the Secretary responsible for that area, and literature is enclosed. Letters of inquiry and carbon copies of our replies are filed geographically by states, and the name of the writer is entered on an alphabetical master file.

Group correspondence is divided geographically and the Senior Secretary gives each Corresponding Secretary the letters from the A.A. groups and members in the territory assigned her. After a Secretary answers her letters, she places them, along with carbon copies of her replies, in the daily folder for the other Secretaries to see. If the letter contains information regarding a change in group records, such as a new Secretary or mailing address, the change is made on the records before the letter is placed in the group folder. Letters containing information about new groups are answered and then held in a special folder pending supply of literature, including a Group Directory and a Secretary's Handbook. Records are then set up for the new group.

The Senior Secretary has the Conference Fund contributions listed and keeps a carbon copy. The original and the monies are turned over to the Treasurer of the Alcoholic Foundation who keeps the financial records and deposits the money in the bank. The name of the group contributing, and the amount, are entered on a card file and any Conference business in the letter is answered by the Conference Secretary. If there are any letters with group problems they are turned over to the Secretary who corresponds with that group. All letters and carbon copies of replies are read by all the Secretaries and by members of the G.S.C. and group records are changed if necessary, before final filing in the group folder.

1 9 5 2

ROSTER OF DELEGATES

Abercrombie, Charles - 21 LeBron Ave., Montgomery, Alabama
 Abare, Lois - 296 Tremont St., Barre, Vermont
 Anderson, Dale - 5705 - 45th Ave., N.E., Seattle, Washington
 Bacheller, Chet - Endicott Hotel, Concord, New Hampshire
 Bancroft, Dave - 114 Decarie Blvd., Ville St. Laurent, Montreal, Quebec, Canada

 Barnard, Thomas W., Jr., - 4341 58th Street, San Diego 15, California
 Bassett, Cecil - Cooperative School Purchasers, Cazenovia, New York
 Bears, Walter M. - P.O. Box 71, Charlottetown, P.E.I., Canada
 Behnfield, Walter - Columbia Road, Morristown, New Jersey
 Bennett, Dr. E.J. - 10 B. 405 Assiniboine Ave., Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada

 Bessette, Reg. - 140 W. Brundage, Sheridan, Wyoming
 Bowers, Floyd H. - 327 Sierra Blvd., Roseville, California
 Bray, Theodore - 46 Grand Blvd., Binghamton, New York
 Brooke, Hilliard T. - P.O. Box 551, Phoenix, Arizona
 Brown, Charlie - 3239 W. 30th, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada

 Brown, R. Fay - Bismarck, North Dakota
 Capeling, Adam T. - 761 Bayview Ave., Toronto, Ontario, Canada
 Cardell, Daryl - 109 Osborne Ave., Margate, New Jersey
 Cawley, William - 95 Belvedere St., Springfield, Massachusetts
 Cole, H.S. - 1219 Clement Place, Silver Springs, Maryland (District of Columbia)

 Collamore, George - 59 Gull Street, New Orleans, Louisiana
 Colquhoun, Joseph - 315 Voorhees Avenue, Buffalo, New York
 Cronin, Pat - 2415 Harriet Ave., Minneapolis, Minnesota
 Daniel, Mrs. Neely - 116 Greenwood Ave., Decatur, Georgia
 Dotson, William I. - 1401 First National Tower, Akron, Ohio

 Duke, Page - 183 Seaton Road, Stamford, Connecticut
 Dunaway, W. George - 12218 106th Street, Edmonton, Alberta, Canada
 Eshleman, H. R. - 773 Trombly Road, Grosse Pointe, Michigan
 Evans, Virgil H. - 311 North Monroe, Green Bay, Wisconsin
 Farrar, Charles I. - Postmaster, Station A, Santa Fe, New Mexico

 Garrett, Kenneth - Box 233, Pine Bluff, Arkansas
 German, Roy - 904 Lavaca Street, Austin, Texas
 Glick, Clifford H. - 327 Dyer Ave., West Palm Beach, Florida
 Goldsberry, Robert, Jr., - 51 St. Stephen Street, Boston, Massachusetts
 Gooderham, Clyde - 871 Westminster, Salt Lake City, Utah

 Griffith, W.G. - 21 Shady Drive West, Pittsburgh 28, Pennsylvania
 Hardin, James C. - 2119 Highland Avenue, So. Charleston, West Virginia
 Harrison, Ray - 320 Fleming Building, Des Moines, Iowa
 Hoare, W. C. - P.O. Box 1027, Astoria, Oregon
 Hunt, Lewis - 617 Grove, Evanston, Illinois

(Continued)

1 9 5 2

ROSTER OF DELEGATES
(Continued)

Ingram, Rowland B. - 1322 West 4th Street, Wilmington, Delaware
Justice, John W. - Cheraw, South Carolina
King, Ernest - 1615 Campus Drive, Toledo 6, Ohio
Kinsley, A.S. - 6010 Brookside - Kansas City, Missouri
Knox, Jack - Nashville Banner, Nashville, Tennessee

Lancaster, Olin - 4678 Fairfax, Dallas, Texas
McIntosh, C. F. - 360 W. Muskegon Ave., Muskegon, Michigan
Madden, George B. - 1412 West Sunset, Decatur, Illinois
Madsen, A. D. - 1145 Ada Ave., Idaho Falls, Idaho
Montgomery, Ward - 700 S. 12th Street, Springfield, Illinois

Mullen, Vincent - 4 Parkside Drive, Providence 7, Rhode Island
Murphy, James - 158 87th Street, Brooklyn, New York
Muzzy, Ray - 437 West Military, Fremont, Nebraska
Nason, Dr. Z. M. - Brotherhood Bldg., Kansas City, Kansas
Nicoson, M. W. - 3040 Halcyon Court, Berkeley, California

Palmersheim, Andy J. - 8 No. 29th Street, Billings, Montana
Paschall, Bert - 1122 Atlas Bldg., Columbus, Ohio
Rehill, Dr. J. F. - Kamsack, Saskatchewan, Canada
Robbins, Merton M. - 32 So. Tejon St., Colorado Springs, Colorado
Roberts, George - 131 Greenwood Ave., Jenkintown, Pennsylvania

Robertson, Arthur E. - Deer River, Minnesota
Scovil, Roy - 1722 N. Lindsay, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma
Sharpe, Thomas A. - Box 6121, Jacksonville, Florida
Sheridan, E. D. - 5020 Griggs Road, Houston, Texas
Simmons, Leo - 216 Alcott Road, Louisville, Kentucky

Simpson, Robert E. - 3205 25th Street, Lubbock, Texas
Storke, Charles F. - 3015 Mary Avenue, Baltimore 15, Maryland
Strachan, George - 617 North 2nd Street, Milwaukee 3, Wisconsin
Strickland, V.D. - Box 26, Rich Square, North Carolina
Thompson, R.W. Jr. - P.O. Box 163, Gulfport, Mississippi

Utterback, James - 31 Kenduskeag Ave., Bangor, Maine
Walker, Cliff - 1163 Ocean View, Whittier, California
White, Jack - Box 5126, Richmond 20, Virginia
White, Robert - 3060 East Kessler Blvd., Indianapolis, Indiana
Wolner, Bill - Box 331, Huron, South Dakota

THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

1 9 5 2

TRUSTEES OF THE ALCOHOLIC FOUNDATION

Non-Alcoholic

Mr. Jack Alexander
1901 Walnut Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Mr. Frank Amos
c/o The Jeffersonian
Cambridge, Ohio

Mr. A. LeRoy Chipman
Allerton House
143 E. 39th Street
New York 16, New York

Mr. Frank Gulden
50 Elizabeth Street
New York, New York

Dr. John Norris
c/o Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

*Mr. Fulton Oursler
Hotel Navarro
112 Central Park South
New York 20, New York

Mr. Bernard B. Smith
551 Fifth Avenue
New York 17, New York

Dr. Leonard V. Strong
133 E. 58th Street
New York 22, New York

Alcoholic

Jonas Anderson
6 Peter Cooper Road
Apt. 14E
New York, New York

Henry F. Grieme
60 E. 42nd Street
New York 17, New York

Gerald McComber
5861 Darlington
Buena Park, California

J. Richard Stanley
2272 Grand View Avenue
Cleveland Heights, Ohio

Earl Treat
Pre-Pared Foods Company
4461 W. Jefferson Avenue
Detroit 9, Michigan

Thomas Yutzy
182 W. 4th Street
New York 11, New York

Henry Zoeller
87-10 Clover Hill Road
Hollis, Long Island, New York

*Deceased
(May 24, 1952)

COMMITTEES OF THE 1952 CONFERENCE *

Nominating

Murphy, N.Y.
 Robbins, Col.
 Kinsley, Mo.
 J. White, Va.
 Nicoson, Calif.
 Eshelman, Mich.
 Duke, Conn.

Finance

Hunt, Ill.
 Lancaster, Tex.
 Nason, Kan.
 Simmons, Ky.
 Hoare, Ore.
 (Grieme, Sec.)

Literature

Sharpe, Fla.
 Glick, Fla.
 Cronin, Minn.
 Brooke, Ariz.
 Knox, Tenn.
 Bowers, Calif.
 Ingram, Del.
 (Brown, Sec.)

Policy

Hardin, West Va.
 Anderson, Wash.
 Harrison, Iowa
 Wolner, S. D.
 Bacheller, N. H.
 Thompson, Miss.
 Bancroft, Que.
 Hitchins, Sec.)

Agenda

Sheridan, Tex.
 Robbins, Col.
 Daniels, Ga.
 Rehill, Sask.
 Colquhoun, N.Y.
 (Mallet, Sec.)

Trustees

Goldsberry, Mass.
 Scovil, Okla.
 Evans, Wis.
 Bennett, Man.
 Palmersheim, Mont.
 (Zoeller, Sec.)

Conference Report

R. White, Ind.
 Abercrombie, Ala.
 Simpson, Tex.
 Utterback, Me.
 Bessette, Wyo.
 (Bugli, Sec.)

* All Conference committees were chosen by lot. Names of committee secretaries in parentheses indicate G.S.O. staff members or volunteers residing in the New York Metropolitan area who are able to work closely with the Office in carrying out committee assignments between Conferences.

STAFF PERSONNEL

HEADQUARTERS

Robert Hitchins
 (President, Works Publishing, Inc.)
 Helen Brown
 Marian Mallet
 Lib Symington
 Ann Macfarlane
 Eve Lum

GRAPEVINE

J. Seegar Heavilin
 John A. Dunlop
 Sigurd P. Sandmore
 Virginia Burneson
 Katherine Swentzel